Launch a skills-and-coach layer for 12,000 employees in 12 weeks, then scale to 45,000 within a year

Siam Pinnacle Group (fictional) · AI-powered Learning Suite · Proposal prepared by Kunanon Jarat · October 2026

Our recommendation

- **Fix the date, flex the scope:** all five parts go live in a thin first version.
- **Replace nothing:** the HR system and both LMSs stay; we add a skills layer on top.
- **AI works only from approved content** and the employee's own record.
- **Security and PDPA start in week 1:** they, not the code, set the critical path.

What goes live at week 12

- **12,000 staff** in Retail & Distribution and Packaging (Thailand): 18 roles, about 85% frontline.
- A 5-minute skill check, an AI-built learning path, and a Thai/English coach beside every lesson.
- A leadership-forum dashboard: 12,000 enabled, 30%+ assessed.

Economics

THB 15.5M
fixed fee to build in 12 weeks

THB 39
per employee per month to run, AI included

THB 80M
client spend over 3 years; 38% gross margin for IRIS

THB 53M a year
value at scale, 2.5x the subscription

SO WHAT The leadership forum sees a working, measurable skills programme for wave 1, at a fixed price, without replacing any system.

Source: IRIS planning model (model/cost-model.xlsx) · all case data synthetic · decisions needed this week: slide 12

Start where 18 role frameworks cover 12,000 people and results show within quarters

Who goes first

WAVE 1 (THAILAND)	PEOPLE	ROLES
Retail & Distribution: stores, DCs	8,500	9
Packaging: 2 plants	3,500	9
Total, with their managers	**12,000**	**18**

- **Few roles, many people:** 18 frameworks cover 12,000.
- **Hardest users first:** shift workers on phones.
- **Results show fast:** shrink, OEE and complaints.
- **Later:** Building Materials and Corporate Services (wave 2); Chemicals and 3 ASEAN countries (wave 3).

What success looks like at week 12

12,000
accounts live, staged over weeks 10-12

30%+
assessed by the forum; 70%+ within 8 weeks

3 days
median manager decision (SLA 5 days)

95%+
coach answers grounded in approved sources

4/5+
learner satisfaction (CSAT)

0
privacy or safety incidents; 99.5% uptime

Assumptions to confirm in week 1

- The HR system exports people, positions and managers daily.
- Both LMSs export catalogue and completions (API, xAPI or CSV); content stays where it is.
- Frontline staff without a corporate account sign in with LINE or employee ID + one-time code.
- IRIS's skill library covers about 70% of wave-1 skills.
- The client provides 2 SMEs per business unit, plus weekly IT security and DPO time.
- Results are for development only, never pay or promotion.

SO WHAT Wave 1 proves the whole loop (assess, plan, learn, approve, measure) on the hardest user group before the wider rollout.

Source: case brief (fictional client) · targets are proposed and agreed with the CHRO in week 1

Ship all five parts in a thin first version, and be explicit about what waits

PART	LIVE AT WEEK 12 (WAVE 1)	NEXT (WAVES 2-3)	NOT NOW
Skill assessment	Self-rating against behaviour descriptions, 3 scenario questions, manager confirms; current and next role	360 input; simulations for safety-critical skills	Certification exams; using results for pay
Learning paths	AI orders approved items from both LMSs: videos, workshop seats and on-the-job projects with evidence	New micro-videos for the top gaps (AI drafts, SMEs approve); peer cohorts	LMS migration (decide in month 9 on usage)
AI coach	Thai/English coach beside each lesson: explains results, suggests next steps, practice, reflection and nudges	Thai voice; 3 ASEAN languages	Open-domain chatbot
Impact dashboard	Employee, manager, HR and leader views; capability baseline and growth; KPI hypotheses per business unit	Causal KPI read, with later waves as the comparison group	Scoring individual performance
Manager approval	Approves results, plan and project evidence; batch approval; 5-day SLA, then escalation to the HRBP	Delegation; weekly manager digest	-

Deliberately left out of week 12: a native app (mobile web + LINE instead), offline mode, gamification, an internal job marketplace, LMS migration and the ASEAN countries. Each adds risk to the date without changing what the CHRO shows the board.

SO WHAT Every part of the mandate is visible at the forum; anything that adds date risk without changing the board story waits.

Source: proposed scope · what the prototype already shows is on slide 12

A mobile learning loop: staff learn on shift, and managers approve three things

1 Sign in with LINE or employee ID

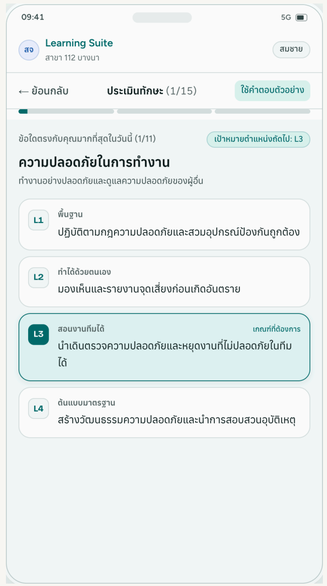
2 5-minute skill check on the phone

3 Manager approves the results (A)

4 AI builds a 12-week path; manager approves (B)

5 Learn on shift; ask the coach beside the lesson

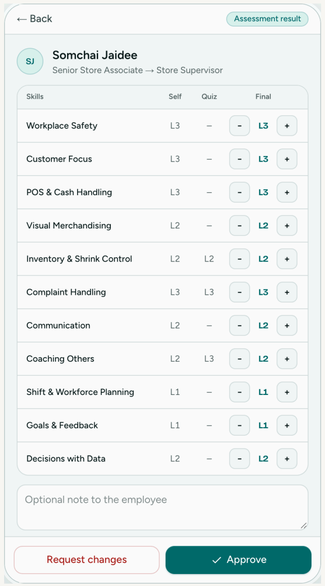
6 Project evidence signed off (C); readiness updates



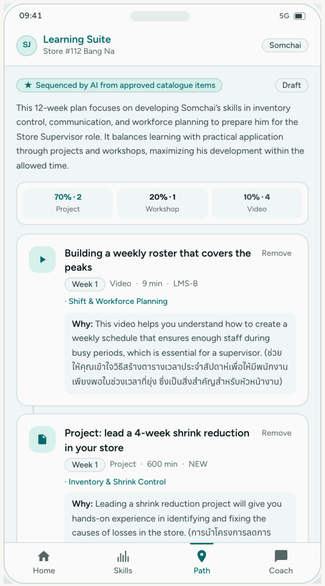
Skill check (Thai)



Next step + nudge



Manager approval



Path with reasons

Managers and HR stay in control

- **Three approvals** (amber): results, the plan and project evidence, with a reason for any change.
- **No bottleneck:** batch review, and escalation to the HRBP after 5 working days.
- **Privacy by role:** managers see direct reports only; HR and leaders see groups of 10 or more.

SO WHAT Frontline staff need one tap and five minutes; managers keep control without becoming a bottleneck.

Screens from an earlier prototype version (Thai and English) · current hosted screens on slide 12

The AI only selects from approved content and the employee's own record, so it cannot invent courses, rules or scores

How the coach answers a question

1. **Knows who is asking.** Sign-in identifies the employee; the coach sees only their own record (server-side access control).
2. **Safety check first.** Rules block colleague data, pay and promotion, prompt injection, wellbeing and crisis topics; ID, phone and email are masked (guardrail layer 1).
3. **Finds approved sources.** Searches lessons and policies in Thai and English (keyword search with Thai word segmentation; semantic search in production).
4. **Answers with citations.** A second check confirms intent, then the answer cites its sources [S1]; if nothing fits, it says so (classifier + grounded answer).
5. **Sensitive topics get fixed replies.** These point to the manager or HRBP, the Employee Assistance Programme or the 1323 crisis line, reviewed with the client before launch.

How the learning path is built

1. **Rules shortlist** approved items by skill gap, level and format.
2. **The AI orders them** and writes a reason for each step, in Thai and English.
3. **Every item is checked** against real catalogue IDs, so nothing is made up.
4. **The manager approves** before the plan goes live.

Thai, done properly

- Thai has no spaces between words, so search splits words first.
- Polite register (ค่ะ / นะคะ) and common work terms kept in English (SBI, OEE).
- Native-speaker review is a release gate.

SO WHAT The client controls the content; the AI only selects, orders and explains it, which keeps every answer defensible to HR and the DPO.

Source: design implemented in the prototype · the live-model quality gate is not yet passed (slide 6)

No AI release goes live without passing a quality gate; the coach costs about THB 6 per active user a month

The release gate, for every model or prompt change

100%	of red-team attacks handled safely (colleague data, pay, injection, PII)
95%+	of answers grounded in approved sources (AI judge + SME sample)
90%+	pass on golden and made-up-course tests; 90%+ correct citations
100%	of replies in the learner's language; Thai quality 4/5+

How we get there

1. **Weeks 3-9:** 300-500 Thai/English test cases per persona and business unit, built with SMEs and native reviewers.
2. **Weeks 9-10:** friendly pilot with 300-500 users; SMEs review flagged answers weekly.
3. **After launch:** track escalations, "no source" rate, satisfaction and cost per user.

Where the prototype stands

- Offline test set: **55/55 passed** (31 original + 24 held-out cases).
- Live run on a free stand-in model (SEA-LION v4): **failed 4 of 7 checks**. Grounded 93% vs 95%, right language 91% vs 100%, golden 86% vs 90%, red team 18/19 (ID masked, answer ungrounded). Citations 100% and Thai 4.9/5 passed.
- Gate stays **closed** until a full run on the costed model passes.

Running cost

THB 6

per coach active user per month, including a 30% buffer

COACH MODEL	SONNET 5.5	OPUS 5.5
Per user per month	THB 6	THB 11
Per year, 45,000 staff	THB 1.3M	THB 2.6M
Share of run cost	10%	18%

Assumes 45% of staff active, 12 messages a month; list prices to revalidate before purchase.

SO WHAT AI quality is measured, not assumed, and AI is only about 10% of run cost, so the model choice will not break the business case.

Source: prototype evaluation runs (offline and live, October 2026) · Anthropic list prices · planning quote, not live billing

Integrate, don't replace: a skills layer on top of the HR system and both LMSs

CHANNELS	Mobile web (app-like)	LINE (mini app)	Desktop / Teams
SIGN-IN	Office staff: corporate sign-in with MFA (OIDC/SAML)	Frontline: LINE or employee ID + one-time code, matched to the HR record	
LEARNING SUITE	Skills and assessment · Path engine · Coach and guardrails · Approvals and SLA · Dashboards Hosted in an approved Thailand cloud region · database, learning-record store, files and audit log		
CONNECTS TO	**HR system:** nightly people, positions and managers	**LMS A + B:** catalogue and completions (API or xAPI); launch by deep link (LTI 1.3); CSV fallback	**AI model:** model, region and data terms validated first

Build, configure or buy

- **Build (IRIS IP, reused across clients):** skills graph, assessment, path engine, coach and guardrails, approvals, dashboards, test harness.
- **Configure (client already has):** sign-in, both LMSs, HR exports, LINE account, BI tool, cloud landing zone.
- **Buy:** AI model access (enterprise terms, no training on client data), managed database, monitoring, SMS, pen test.

Why not buy a skills platform?

Procurement, security review and data migration don't fit in 12 weeks. Integrating keeps exit options open, and IRIS's method is the differentiator.

SO WHAT Nothing is migrated in 12 weeks, so the real work is integration and frontline sign-in (amber), not a platform change.

Source: proposed production design · the prototype runs on a managed web host with managed sign-in and database (slide 12)

A small data model with privacy built in from week 1: the riskiest data never reaches the AI

What we store

DATA	KEY FIELDS	SOURCE
Employee	role, manager, site, language	HR system
Role and role skills	business unit, grade, next roles; required level, critical flag	IRIS + SMEs
Skill	levels 1-4, each with behaviours	IRIS library
Assessment	self, check, manager, final, status	Suite
Learning item	LMS, format, skill and level, sessions	LMS A / B
Plan and approvals	target role, week, reason, status; approver, decision, due date	Suite
KPI	business unit or site, period, value (aggregate only)	BU finance

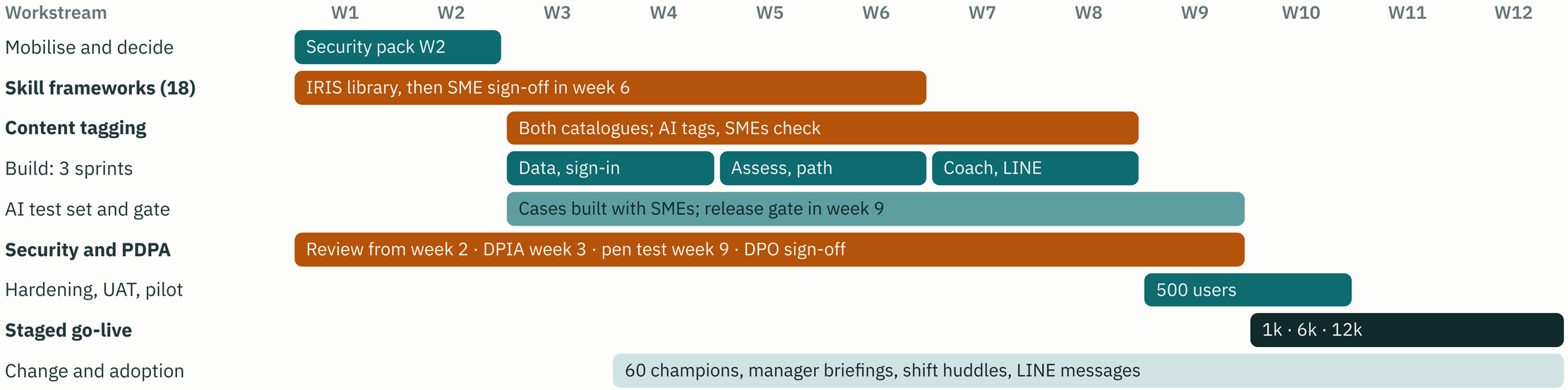
How we protect it

CONTROL	HOW
Lawful basis	DPO and counsel confirm the basis for learning records and AI personalisation
DPIA	Done by week 3; DPO approves before any employee data is used
Minimum data	Own role, skills and plan only; ID, phone and email masked; no salary or colleagues' records
Cross-border	Hosting, AI provider region, retention and no-training terms validated before purchase
Access	Own record and direct reports only; leaders see groups of 10+; HR access audited
Security	SSO + MFA, encryption, web firewall, OWASP and AI top-10 tests; pen test week 9
Retention	Employment + 1 year; chats 90 days (to confirm with the DPO)

SO WHAT Privacy approval is on the critical path, so it starts in week 1 (security pack to IT in week 2), not week 10.

Source: Thai PDPA (s.28/29 cross-border transfers, PDPC DPIA guidance) · production decisions need client counsel and DPO sign-off

12 weeks with a staged go-live from week 10; security, data and frameworks set the critical path



Amber = critical path **Gates:** W2 security pack · W6 frameworks and demo · W9 AI gate + pen test · W10 security/DPO go/no-go · W12 all enabled

IRIS team: 14.2 average FTE (about 17 people) including delivery lead, architect, 4 engineers, AI engineer, data engineer, QA, designer, DevSecOps, skills lead, 2 consultants, content analyst and change lead.

Client team: HR product owner, HR system owner, 2 LMS admins, IT security, DPO, 2 SMEs per business unit and 60 champions. A weekly product council keeps the date fixed and lets scope flex.

SO WHAT Going live in stages from week 10 means one bad week still lands before the forum: the forum is the deadline, not the target.

Source: proposed delivery plan · team cost in the IRIS planning model

The top risks to the date have weekly owners and fallbacks; scaling to 45,000 means more frameworks, not a rebuild

RISK TO THE DATE	LEVEL	MITIGATION	FALLBACK
Security or PDPA approval late	High	Security pack in week 2; weekly clinic with IT security; reuse their approved cloud patterns	Approved reduced mode; otherwise defer employee-data use
Frameworks not agreed	High	Start from the IRIS library (~70% reuse); SME sign-off by week 6; monthly updates	Current-role frameworks only; next role later
HR and LMS data quality	High	Profile data in weeks 1-2; job-code mapping; a "wrong manager?" button; CSV fallback	Approvals go to the HRBP
Scope creep across 5 BUs	High	Product council with the CHRO delegate; change control; backlog for later waves	Move it to wave 2
Frontline access and adoption	Med	LINE entry; 5-minute check in shift huddles; 60 champions; 2 h a month of paid learning time	Supervisor-led sessions on shared tablets
AI quality in Thai	Med	Release gate; narrow scope; fixed replies for sensitive topics; weekly SME review	Coach answers lesson content only

Wave 1 · month 4
12,000 people
Retail & Distribution and Packaging, Thailand. Prove the whole loop and set the baseline.

Wave 2 · month 7
+15,000 people
Building Materials, Corporate Services and the rest of Thailand. AI drafts frameworks from job descriptions; SMEs check them.

Wave 3 · month 13
+18,000 people
Chemicals and 3 ASEAN countries: local languages, a DPIA per country, local content.

SO WHAT The platform is built once; growth costs content work, and run cost falls from about THB 62 to THB 25 per employee a month.

Source: proposed risk register and rollout plan · run cost from the IRIS planning model

THB 15.5M fixed to build and THB 39 per employee a month to run; the value is about 2.5x the subscription

What it costs IRIS

THB 7.3M
to build in 12 weeks: team 5.9M, third-party 0.8M, contingency 0.6M

THB 62
run cost per employee a month at 12,000 staff

THB 25
at 45,000 staff (month 36)

Run cost at scale: people 66% · cloud 14% · **AI 11%** · other 9%

Margin on the build fee: **52.8%**; over 3 years: **38.5%**.

What we propose to charge

1. **THB 15.5M fixed build fee,** including a 10% premium for the fixed date; paid 30 / 30 / 40.
2. **THB 39 per employee per month** for platform, hosting, AI coach and second-line support; minimum 20,000 from wave 2; 3-year term.
3. **Fixed rollout fees:** wave 2 THB 6M; wave 3 THB 9M, including ASEAN localisation.
4. **10% of the subscription at risk** on adoption KPIs; nothing tied to business KPIs until there is a baseline.

What the client gets back

THB M	Y1	Y2	Y3	TOTAL
Client pays	29.2	30.1	21.1	**80.3**
IRIS profit	11.0	12.2	7.7	**31.0**

THB 53M a year
value at scale: L&D spend redirected 14.9 · internal hires 14.4 · shrink 18.0 · OEE 4.0 · admin 2.0

Break-even check: a 3.5% relative cut in shrink alone covers the subscription. Steady state is THB 468 per employee a year, 14% of today's L&D spend per head.

SO WHAT IRIS carries the date risk and is paid for it; the client pays as it scales, and one value lever alone covers the subscription.

Source: IRIS planning model (1,207 formulas, zero errors, 143 independent checks) · 38.5% gross margin · value to validate with client finance in weeks 1-2

Four decisions this week keep the forum date safe; a working prototype already shows the core loop

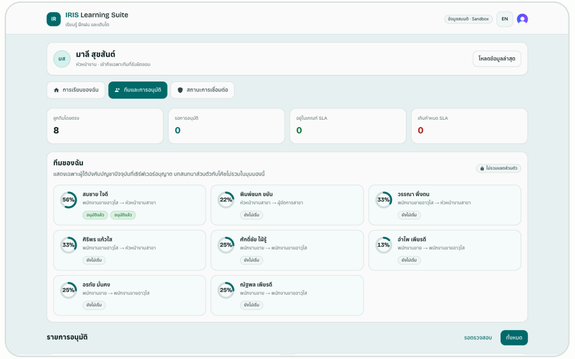
Decisions needed this week

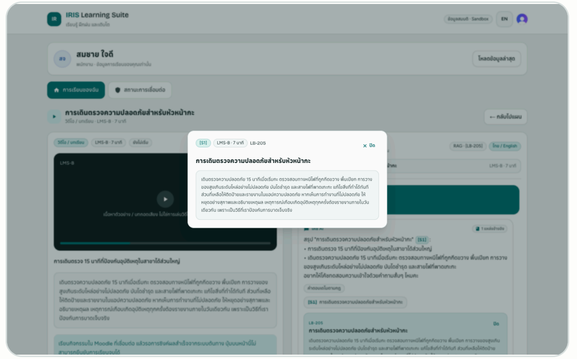
1. **Confirm wave 1** (Retail & Distribution and Packaging, Thailand) and the week-12 success criteria.
2. **Name the client team:** HR product owner, 2 SMEs per business unit, weekly IT security and DPO time.
3. **Start the security pack and DPIA** so they land in weeks 2 and 3.
4. **Agree the commercial model in principle:** fixed build fee plus per-employee subscription.

Then

W1 mobilise and check assumptions · **W2** security pack · **W3** DPIA · **W6** frameworks and demo · **W9** AI gate · **W10** go/no-go

What the prototype shows today





- **Live:** iris-learning-suite.vercel.app (test logins in the cover email), with sign-in, assessment, manager approvals, AI path and the coach beside lessons.
- **AI tests:** offline 55/55 passed; a live run on a free stand-in model failed 4 of 7 checks, so the gate is not yet passed.
- **Integrations:** HR and Moodle connectors proven in a local sandbox only.

Tools used

- Original draft: Claude Code and Cursor.
- Continuation: Codex and Cursor for sign-in, security, evaluations, integrations and docs; Claude Code for coach updates, security fixes and this deck.
- Live evaluation: SEA-LION v4 coach with a Qwen3 judge.

SO WHAT Approving these four decisions this week starts week 1 on time; everything else in the plan follows from them.

Mock data only: fictional company, people and courses · prototype screens from the hosted sandbox